

Dyson Districts Program

1. Program Overview

- **Dyson Districts** is a semester-long house competition designed to build community among Dyson freshmen.
- Incoming students will be **sorted into six houses during orientation**, creating smaller communities within the class.
- Throughout the semester, houses will participate in **team challenges, social activities, and academic competitions** to earn points and build connections within Dyson.

2. House System

- All incoming Dyson freshmen are **assigned to one of six houses during Orientation**.
- Each house represents a Ithaca waterfall or gorge in celebration of Cornell's campus
- Houses compete throughout the semester to earn points toward the **Dyson Districts Cup** which will be awarded to one house at the end of the semester
- Leadership roles will be assigned to upperclassmen through voluntary basis to facilitate activities and maximize engagement for first year students

3. Orientation Kickoff Event

Goal: Introduce the program, build excitement, and foster early connections.

Components:

- Welcome and overview of **Dyson Districts**
- **Bandana distribution** for house representation
- Announcement of house identities and teams
- **Kickoff Scavenger Hunt** (typically will take place the weekend after orientation)
 - Teams complete campus-based challenges
 - Tasks designed to introduce:
 - Key Dyson spaces
 - Cornell campus landmarks
 - Collegetown cafes and food spots
 - Houses earn their **first points of the semester**

4. Semester-Long Challenges

Throughout the semester, houses earn points through a variety of activities.

Examples of Challenge Categories:

- Attending Cornell events or activities
- Social events hosted by the Dyson Undergraduate Council
- Dyson knowledge and trivia
- Collaboration challenges between houses

Points accumulate over the semester to determine the **winning house**.

5. Asynchronous Engagement

To keep participation flexible and continuous, many challenges will run **asynchronously**.

Instagram

- Biweekly challenge posts
- Story polls and trivia
- Submission-based competitions (photos, short videos, etc.)
- Social Media leaderboard updates

GroupMe

- House-specific communication channels
- Event announcements and reminders
- Challenge instructions and submissions
- Real-time engagement and discussion within houses

6. Incentives and Recognition

- **Points leaderboard** updated regularly
- End-of-semester **Dyson Districts Champion House**
- Potential rewards:
 - Trophy or Dyson Districts Cup
 - Small prizes or celebratory event

7. Program Goals

- Build **stronger community among Dyson freshmen**
- Encourage **cross-student engagement outside the classroom**
- Create **Dyson traditions that continue across cohorts**
- Provide a fun and structured way for students to explore campus and connect with peers

Pre-Activity

- About Us
- Chant
- Onboarding
 - Cup
 - GroupMe

Activity Ideas

Team building circle. You can't step outside of the circle. It is a big circle. The team is inside. You have one person at a time stretch out and put a marker as far away from them as possible. Then you go back into the circle and you try and get it again with your teammates without touching the outside of the circle. Get everyone on the team to put a marker down and they have to go reach it.

Relay races. Wheelbarrow race, egg on a spoon.

The floor is Lava, and you give them just enough frisbees so that it is fitting about 3 people to 1 frisbee. Then they have to get to the end and it is very hard to do almost impossible, but its very fun.

Inventory:

- Megaphone
- Signs
- Frisbees
- Spoons, balls
- Tape / Rope
- Bandanas for leaders
- Water balloons

Web App

- Leaderboard
- Schedule of events

Video for what it is

Create your own code of culture- no overlap during orientation.